

The Kitchen by Andrea Galano

Toro & gal sherizly

It was a hot day in early July 2022, and we had too little time to collect too many words and prepare them with just a few hands. We sat around the kitchen table. Sipping golden oat milk. Hoping. Daydreaming our bodies awake. The silence of our empty cups stared back at us. Should we refill them to break this silence? Filling a cup or breaking a silence is a privilege that few have. It reminded us of gathering in the reading circle with Audre Lorde's "The Transformation of Silence into Language and Action." It was in this circle where we first met as guest students and discussed: Which words are needed to transform silence into agency? How can we rethink language to expand our worldviews, our palettes? Our response was to create a glossary for the final activation of *Planetary Embodiment*. But still the issue of time remained.

As we refilled the cups, we contemplated the privilege of dreaming and how rest nourishes creativity. We took another sip, and asked ourselves: Are we rushing the cooking-process for the sake of a final product? How can only a few hands cook a planetary meal? How can we make knowledging a collective exercise? In dialogue with Luíza Luz, previously our teacher, now our collaborator, we envisioned the possibilities of crafting this project through workshops in the following semesters. With this seed, the classroom, the kitchen, slowly became fertile soil for this collaborative cookbook.

As preparation for the workshops, participants created a collective ingredient list of words that are necessary for breaking silences and taking action. In the first workshop, "Cooking Dreams," held in November 2022, participants were invited to co-write recipes for the four phases of dreaming. They explored the bodily reactions of each phase as well as their oniric state. Dreaming referred to the dreams that keep us awake, those that wake our collective agency. How can hallucinations, body jerks, sleep paralysis or lucid dreaming be translated into action?

The second workshop, "Being all Ears," held in May 2023, was inspired by the teachings of Pauline Oliveros. An invitation to embody the practice of Deep Listening from inward to outward, starting in the classroom. Through breathing, sounding and practising Qigong we tuned ourselves as a form of self-care. Outside the university, we engaged with the more-than-human, transforming the non-audible: the visual, tangible, smellable, and tastable – into threads of an inter-woven story.

While the content of these pages was fermenting, we rolled up our sleeves and went out in the fields of word-worlding, collecting more terms to be defined. When we say define, we turn away from rigid dictionary definitions, and instead move towards thoughtful engagement with words, broadening their intentions and embarking on speculative journeys into their potential impacts. We think-with words that are

at reach to us at the moment, aware that some might be missing in the present, or even become irrelevant in the future(s). This cookbook aspires to meander beyond the false limitations of language, cross illusive borders, and create space for new wor(l)ds. These words are ingredients for an experimental potluck. They live outside of definitions and spill beyond the confinements of a square table. The recipes can be cooked to taste. They are an invitation for you to create new recipes, with existing ingredients or new ones.

The format of this book is not bound by words, nor glue, it is open-ended, and non-finite. We serve you these knowledge(s) as an aperitivo to evoke appetite when thinking and acting. The empty terms and free spaces are yours to define. What will you fill your empty cup with? Feel invited to add your own paper, fill it with the stream of your imagination and thoughts, your own personal touch.

As a reader you are welcome to join us in the kitchen, the classroom and beyond. Get curious, try out new ingredients, mix the seemingly unmixable, the bitter and sweet, the rational and the intuitive. Use your tongue to perceive unfamiliar flavours, and various mother tongues. Get creative, compost the rotten, revive the dead with a dash of a new beginning, use waste as inspiration for unexpected combinations.

Let's fill our cups with Ursula Le Guin's "The Carrier Bag Theory of Fiction." As we drink, the author reminds us that for centuries his-story was a man-made weapon, repeating violent narratives with a hero at the centre of attention. Her-story instead, uses language as a medicine for the ruins, tending to more-than-human approaches and a polyphonic storytelling. Let this book be infused with their-stories. Creating a kaleidoscope of narratives that is not yet a final dish but rather a growing conversation starter. We'll hand you the aprons, the rest is up to you.